

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Birthday Cakes

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 13

NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS - A change over time

No.	Sentence
1	In the past, most birthday cakes were _____.
2	Many present-day cakes are edible _____ rather than plain party food.
3	Her favourite fruit flavours for a cake are _____.
4	She values the cake's taste and _____ more than a tidy appearance.
5	Customers have seen his _____, which helps them trust him with a new commission.
6	He wants his finished cakes to be _____ to the people receiving them, even after the celebration.
7	To develop decoration ideas, he learns about each person's _____.

11 What broader change in birthday cakes does the discussion describe?

- A Cakes have increasingly become edible designs that reflect the person celebrating.
- B Cakes have increasingly been chosen for the number of candles they can hold.
- C Cakes have increasingly followed one standard design for every celebration.
- D Cakes have increasingly been prepared at home for a more personal occasion.

12 Why would an unevenly decorated cake still suit the first baker's ideal?

- A It could show that the cake was made without any planning.
- B It could take less time to make than a carefully flavoured cake.
- C It could still be fresh and taste the way she wants.
- D It could make the customer's hobbies easier to recognise.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **How are the two approaches to birthday cakes presented?**
- A The first baker seeks impressive decoration; the newer baker values speed above appearance.
 - B The first baker favours simple, flavourful cakes; the newer baker gives greater attention to visual design.
 - C The first baker follows customers' hobbies; the newer baker prefers familiar fruit flavours.
 - D The first baker creates cakes to be remembered; the newer baker focuses on making them at home.
- 14 **What makes designing cakes personally satisfying for the second baker?**
- A It lets him repeat earlier designs for a wider range of customers.
 - B It lets him avoid learning about the people receiving the cakes.
 - C It lets him judge how long other bakers spend on each cake.
 - D It gives him room to express himself through his work.
- 15 **A new client says, "I trust your ideas; you choose the design." Which response best fits the second baker's approach?**
- A He develops his own ideas while keeping the client's satisfaction in mind.
 - B He develops the cake without considering the recipient.
 - C He assumes the client is no longer concerned with appearance.
 - D He promises to reproduce a cake from his earlier designs.
- 16 **What does the baker enjoy about revealing the finished cake?**
- A The reveal helps him decide whether to change the cake's flavour.
 - B The reveal gives him a chance to see whether the customer is pleased.
 - C The reveal is when his clients first grant him design freedom.
 - D The reveal shows that every cake takes longer than clients expect.